SECURITY AWARENESS

Ransomware: Don't Get Locked Out



How it works, how to spot it, and what to do.

[Organisation name] · [Presenter] · [Date]

What is ransomware?

Malicious software that locks your files and demands a ransom to unlock them.

Files are **encrypted**: scrambled so no one can open them without a key.

Many attackers also **steal data** and threaten to publish it.



Why it matters to all of us



Work stops

Systems go offline. We can't serve customers or do our jobs, sometimes for weeks.



Data is exposed

Personal and confidential information can be stolen and leaked.



Costs and trust

Recovery is expensive, and our reputation can take years to rebuild.

How ransomware gets in

Phishing emails

Infected attachments or links in convincing messages.

Unsafe downloads

Fake updates, pirated software and infected USB drives.

Unpatched systems

Skipped updates leave known security holes open.

Weak or stolen passwords

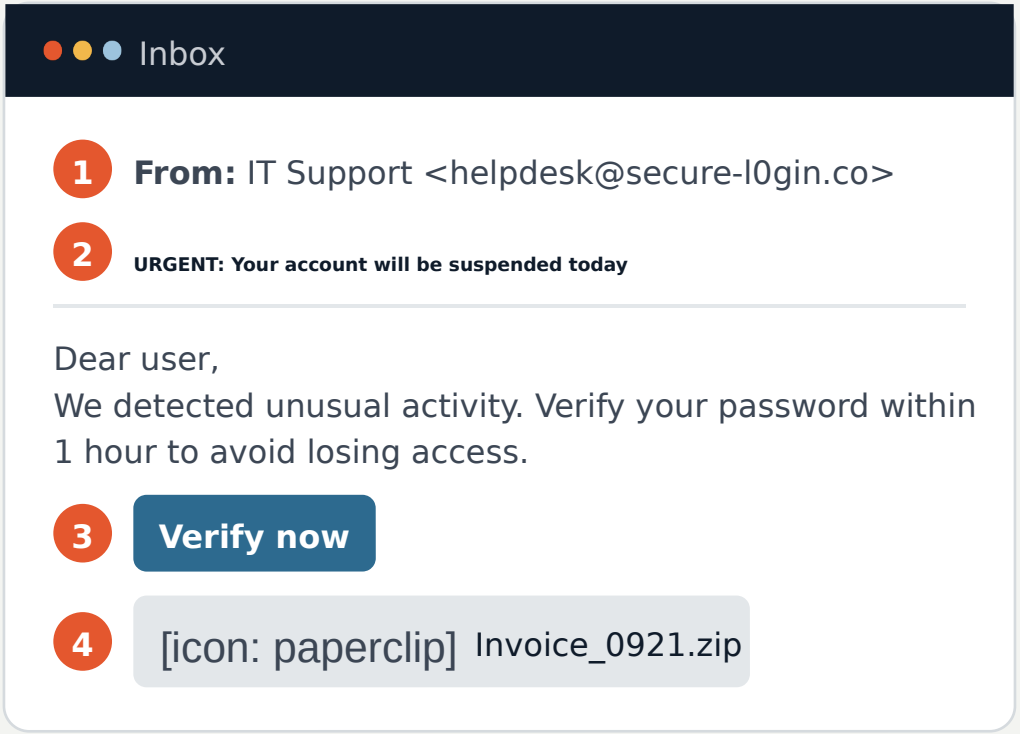
Attackers log in remotely using reused or guessed passwords.

Anatomy of an attack



Attackers may wait **days or weeks** between entry and encryption. Early reporting can stop them.

Spotting a phishing email



1. **Odd sender address**
   Misspelled or look-alike domains.
2. **Urgency or threats**
   Pressure to act before you think.
3. **Suspicious links**
   Hover first: does the address match?
4. **Unexpected attachments**
   Zip files, macros or "invoices".

Warning signs of an infection

Strange file names

Files renamed with unfamiliar extensions.

Files won't open

Documents show errors or scrambled content.

A ransom message

A pop-up or text file demanding payment.

Unusual behaviour

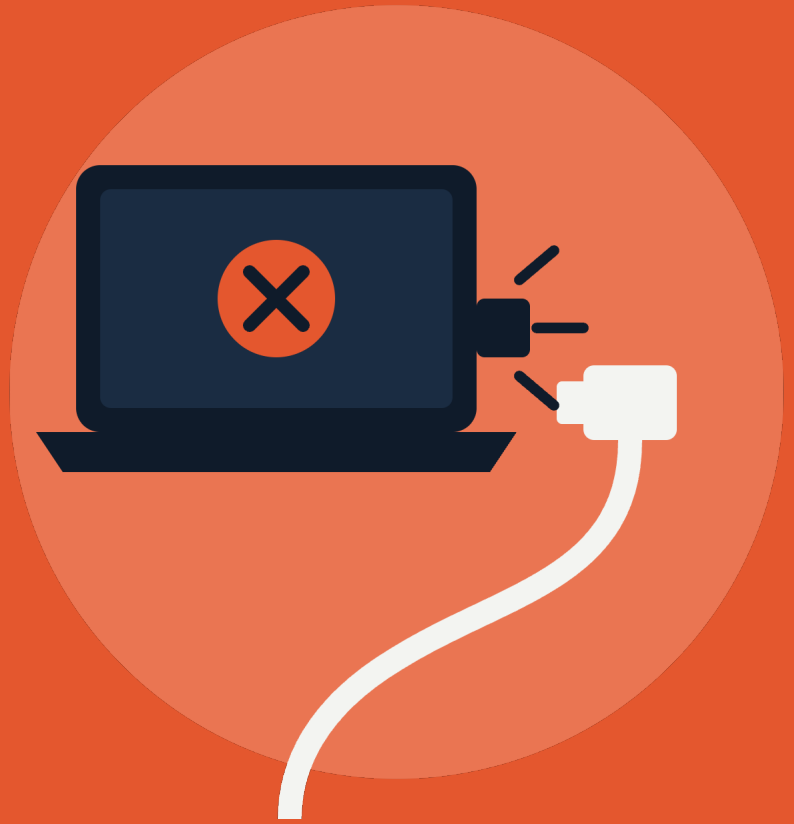
Very slow PC, or antivirus suddenly off.

[icon: alert-triangle] Notice any of these? **Act immediately**: every minute counts.

IF YOU SUSPECT RANSOMWARE

Disconnect.
Report.
Don't pay.

Speed matters more than anything else.



What to do, step by step

1. **Disconnect from the network:** unplug the cable and turn off Wi-Fi.
2. **Leave the device powered on** unless IT tells you otherwise.
3. **Call the IT helpdesk immediately** on [extension / number].
4. **Note what you saw:** take a photo of the screen with your phone.
5. **Don't pay, reply or try to fix it** yourself.



Six habits that stop ransomware

Think before you click

Pause on links and attachments.

Install updates

Restart when prompted; don't delay.

Strong passwords + MFA

Unique passwords and two-step login.

Save to approved storage

Keep work where it's backed up.

Approved software only

No pirated apps or unknown USBs.

Report early

Suspicious? Tell IT straight away.

Who to contact

IT helpdesk

[Extension]

Call first for any suspected incident

Report phishing

[security@...]

[Or the Report Phishing button]

Out of hours

[Number]

[On-call security contact]

[icon: bookmark] Save these contacts now, on your phone as well as your computer.

REMEMBER

You are the human firewall.

Think before you click. Report anything suspicious.

Thank you · Questions?

